LEVEL DESIGN DOCUMENT

Biohazard Department

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HAVE A NICE DEATH



Intentions :

- The **Biohazard Department** World aims to serve as a possible alternative to the Industrial Pollution Department and Toxic Food-Processing Department.
- A **transitional world** that helps the player grow in power.
- Introduction of mechanics and enemies that launch **poisoned attacks**, adding a status-effect dimension over a defined period of time.
- Enemies with **grotesque**, **deformed appearances**, wearing gas masks...
- Symbolism centered on the **corruption of the scientific field** and abuses carried out in laboratories.

References and Inspirations

South Park : The Fractured But Whole

- Criticism delivered through an offbeat tone regarding scientific experiments on animals, whose necessity remains highly debatable.



Toxic Waste Land - Janis Zihmanis

- • Radioactive-toned colors, depicting humanity slowly poisoning itself.



Detailed structure of the World's levels for the first run

Random levels 1 to 3:

- Levels offering resources (Soulary Service, Vita-Mana Service, Anima Depot, intriguing floor, hazardous floor, low probability of encountering the Thanager's Office)

Level 4 :

- Thanager's Office or random resource level

Level 5 :

- HR Office or random resource level

Level 6 :

- Maintenance Room or Store

Level 7 :

- World Boss Arena

General architecture of the levels

- **Room types:**
- Short exploration rooms
  - Descent into the depths with slightly branching off paths
  - Presence of 3 to 5 enemies, 1 of which can attack from the air, and 2 at range
  - Presence of poisonous gas zones that poison the player
  - Chemical scenery: pipes, overturned containers, warning signs, in greenish/yellowish tones to distinguish the world from the others
- Arenas
  - Symmetrical or circular layouts to encourage fast movement, with a few variations to add difficulty
- Boss/Maintenance Room /Store
  - Clean layout adding a touch of the current World through its scenery

Structure of a resource-gain / introductory level

- Start: the player spawns at the top of the level and immediately begins a descent.
- Around 3 or more different enemies distributed throughout the level to vary the combat.
- The player is immediately confronted by two different enemy types.
- Followed by an arena (enemy waves).
- After the arena, return to normal progression, continuing the descent with previously encountered enemies, preparing for the exit.

Total level duration: ~1 min 20 sec–2 mins

Diagram of a room in a resource-gain level

Descent Room placed at the start of a level



Legend:

- Entry Point
- Enemy's Spawn
- Pass-ThroughPlatform
- Soulary Reward Point

Modular grid:

All layout are built using a 1x1 tile grid, matching the game's modular level construction system.

Detailed diagram of a room in a resource-gain level

Path focused on the readability of routes; throughout the room, the player faces enemies without being overwhelmed

- Entrance (via the left platform)
  - Spawn in a wide space, allowing freedom to dash
  - This freedom is broken by a short horizontal path leading to the descent
- Central descent
  - A change of pace introduced through a narrow drop
  - Possibility of exploration to gain Soulary
    - Interconnection between levels allowing exploration without making the player retrace their steps

Diagram of an arena for a resource-gain level

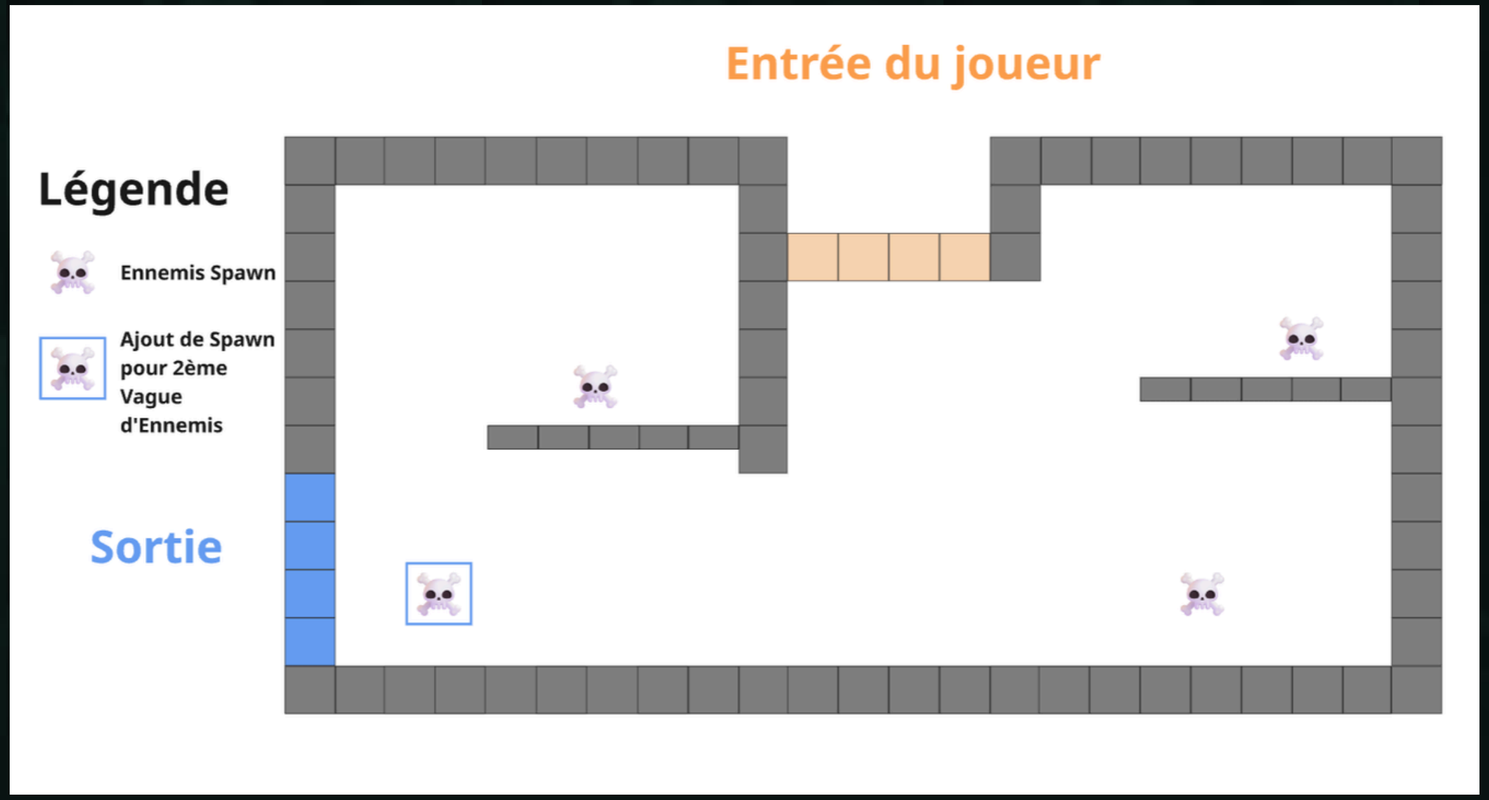
Intentions:

- Straight-forward design to challenge the player without making the encounter overly difficult
- Almost symmetrical and confined layout, drawing on the theme of a cramped laboratory

Legend:

Enemy's Spawn

Enemy's Spawn for Second Wave



Structure of an HR Office level – intermediate difficulty

- Beginning of the level: the player spawns at the bottom right in a calm area, with an immediate ascent to leave the alcove.
- Presence of 5 enemies distributed throughout the level (open areas, elevated positions, near toxicareas), leading to variations in pacing and danger.
- Introduction of an environmental hazard: toxic zones. The player must adapt their movement to avoid damage.
- Final ascending phase, mixing platforms, toxic zones, and elevated enemies, requiring good mastery of movement before reaching the exit

Total level duration: ~1 min 20 sec–2 mins

Diagram of an HR Office level room

Example of the architecture of an HR Office level room

- Introduction to toxic zones
- Room teeming with all types of enemies



Legend:

Entry Point

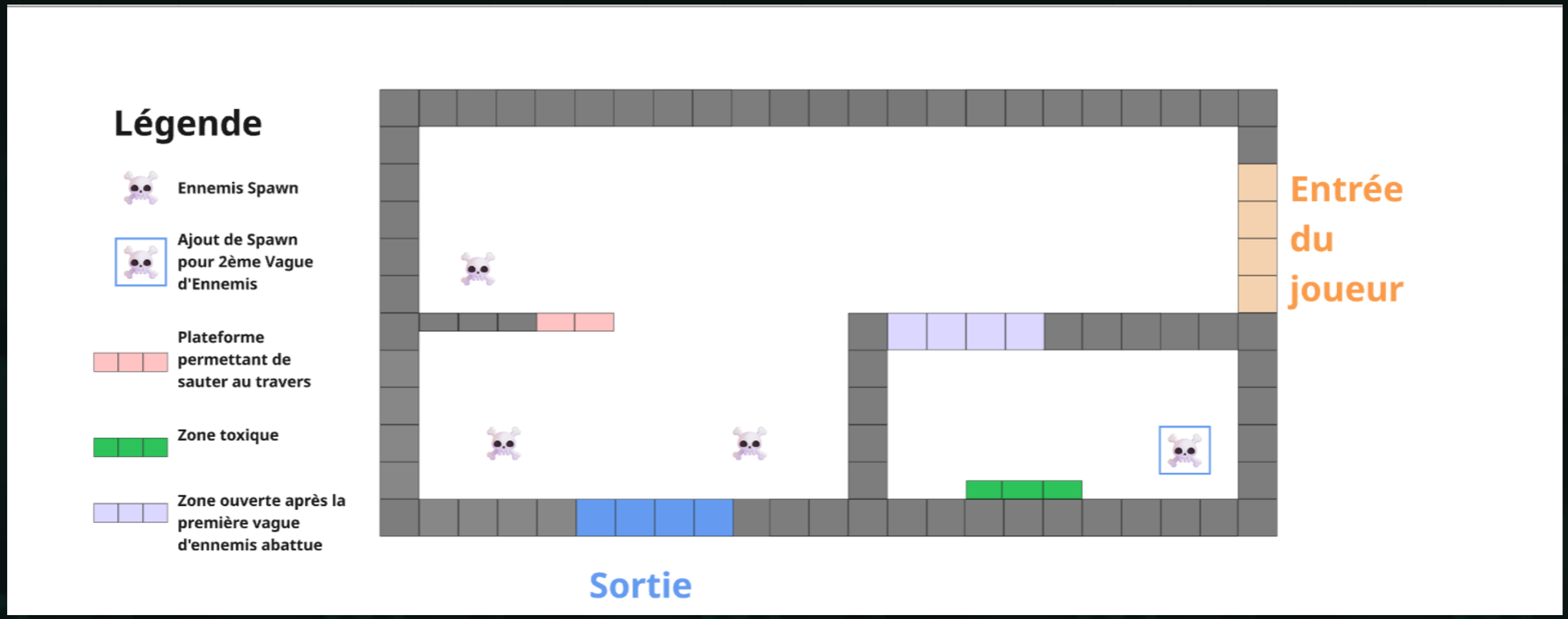
Poison Zone

Enemy's Spawn

Pass-ThroughPlatform

Soulary Reward Point

Schéma d'une arène pour niveau de Bureau RH



Level Design intention for the arena in the HR Office level

- This design increases the difficulty for the player through the use of two mechanics:
  - Opening a door once a threshold number of enemies defeated has been reached.
  - Using a toxic zone in a confined area, with its placement requiring dexterity from the player.

3 different enemy types; the enemy in the second wave is intentionally easier to kill to avoid causing too much frustration for the player.

Summary of the 4 rooms

- **Rooms completed:**
  - **Room 1:** introduces a contrast between freedom of movement characterized by wide spaces and restriction through narrow spaces.
  - **Arena 1:** the player must naturally make an effort to attack a specific target while also being targeted by the other enemies.
  - **Room 2:** increased difficulty through the addition of toxic zones, with a larger number of enemies placed both vertically and horizontally.
  - **Arena 2:** complex combat marked by environmental constraints, the two different mechanics at play, the reduced space, and vertical mobility.

- **Overall intentions:**
  - Alternate calm exploration phases and intense combat, the core of the gameplay.
  - Introduce environmental mechanics to surprise the player and create difficulties in their movement.
  - Control the player's pace through the vertical layout, reducing or enlarging areas.